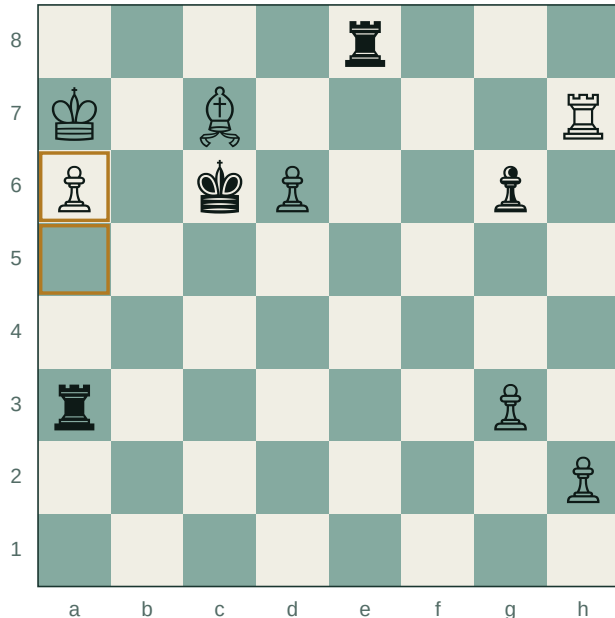


Attraction tactics: Black, move 41

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 41.a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41...Rxa6+ 42. Kxa6 Ra8#

41...Rxa6+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on a6. Recorded reply: **42.Kxa6**.

42...Ra8# Mate: rook on a8 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on a7. Absolute pin: pawn on a6.